

cartridge, and when we need four of them, we spend well over \$200 in one shopping trip!

A lot of people use recycled ink/toner to cut this cost, and if you had asked me a year ago, I would have recommended it too. But the more I use recycled toner (at least from all the brands I've tried), the more I'm dissatisfied long term with the results.

The products generally start out okay, but then they goop up the inside of my printer or leave colored streaks on all my pages. I've never had this problem whenever I've bought a brand new cartridge, which is why despite the price, I tend to buy exclusively new. However, if a reader-recommended site came across my desk, I would definitely be willing to try again!

Here are my three favorite places to buy new cartridges:

- At Staples, you get up to 5% cash back on every purchase, including ink, as well as \$2 for every ink cartridge you recycle. Psst...there's almost always a sale or rebate on printer paper too!
- Through Office Depot, you get 10% cash back on ink purchases, plus points equal to approximately \$2 for every ink cartridge you recycle.
- At [Amazon.com](https://www.amazon.com), cartridges can be up to \$10 cheaper, which, depending on price, makes it a better deal than your local office supply store—even with the cash back percentage.

Another way to make the ink you use last a lot longer is to print only what you need, print it in black and white, and print only in draft mode. For a laser printer, this doesn't really matter all that much, but for inkjets, it makes a huge difference when you don't need professional quality!

READER TIP:

We have used [SuppliesOutlet.com](https://www.suppliesoutlet.com) for a few years now with no problems. They have great prices!

—Kelly, NY